



**OFFICIAL RULEBOOK FOR
SPARKEEC 1.0
A 27-HOUR INTERNAL HACKATHON**

*“Innovate for Impact: Harnessing Artificial Intelligence and Emerging Technologies
for Sustainable Development”*



**ORGANIZED BY
SOCISE-EEC**

Society of Computer, IT and Software Engineering
Everest Engineering College

IN COLLABORATION WITH

AWS Student Builder Group – EEC
IEEE Student Chapter – EEC

17th – 18th July 2026

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0. Quick Facts

Item	Detail
Dates	17th – 18th July 2026 (27 continuous hours)
Venue	Everest Engineering College, Sanepa-2, Lalitpur
Eligibility	Currently enrolled EEC students, any program/year
Team Size	2 to 4 members (solo registrants are matched into teams)
Registration Fee	NPR 25 per participant
Build Window	09:00, Day 1 → 12:00 noon, Day 2 (hard deadline)
Theme	Innovate for Impact: AI & Emerging Tech for Sustainable Development
Tracks	7 tracks — choose one at registration (see Section 3)
Mentorship / Checkpoints	5 rounds; a code push to GitHub is mandatory before each
Judging	3 panels — Technology (45%), Business (30%), Investment (25%)
Total Cash Prizes	NPR 26,000 + goodies, sponsor prizes & incubation support

Full details, obligations, and procedures follow in the sections below. This document is binding on every participant, mentor, judge, volunteer, and organizer of SparkEEC 1.0.

1. Key Definitions

Term	Meaning
The Event	The 27-hour hackathon, 17–18 July 2026, at EEC.
Participant	An enrolled EEC student with confirmed registration, on a registered Team.
Team	A group of 2–4 Participants registered under one team name.
Build Window	The continuous 27-hour development period (09:00 Day 1 – 12:00 noon Day 2).
Official Repository	The GitHub repository assigned to a Team inside the SOCISE-SparkEEC organization; the only repository used for judging.
Mentorship Round	A scheduled mentor visit that also serves as a mandatory code-push checkpoint.
Submission	The complete deliverable package (Section 14) delivered before the hard deadline.
Judging Panel	The panel of technology, business, and investment judges plus senior judges (Section 17).

All times in this Rulebook are Nepal Standard Time (NPT). Where this Rulebook conflicts with a verbal statement, the Rulebook prevails unless the Event Lead issues a written amendment. The Event Lead's interpretation of any rule is final, subject to the appeals process in Section 24.

2. Purpose, Scope & Theme

2.1 Purpose & Scope

This Rulebook governs fairness, safety, and transparency at SparkEEC 1.0. It applies to all Participants, Teams, volunteers, mentors, judges, and organizers, from registration through the post-event period. Completing registration is unconditional acceptance of this Rulebook; continued participation after any published amendment is acceptance of that amendment.

2.2 Official Theme

“Innovate for Impact: Harnessing Artificial Intelligence and Emerging Technologies for Sustainable Development.” Every project must apply AI and/or emerging technology (web, mobile, IoT, data, cloud) to a clearly stated real-world problem with a defined target user, and should articulate how the solution advances sustainable development — Nepal-relevant problems (transport safety, agriculture, education, healthcare, disaster resilience, tourism) are especially encouraged.

3. Official Problem Tracks

Each Team selects exactly one track at registration; the selection may be revised until the end of ideation on Day 1, after which it is locked. The Organizing Committee may rebalance tracks during screening for fair distribution.

Track	Illustrative Focus	Aligned SDGs
AI & Smart Automation	Assistants, computer vision, predictive analytics, generative AI	SDG 9, 8
Sustainable Cities & Mobility	Smart transport, road/bus safety, energy, waste management	SDG 11, 13
AgriTech & Food Security	Crop monitoring, supply-chain transparency, market access	SDG 2, 12
HealthTech & Wellbeing	Telemedicine, diagnostics, mental health, accessibility	SDG 3
EdTech & Digital Inclusion	Learning platforms, rural access, literacy, language tools	SDG 4, 10
FinTech & Financial Inclusion	Digital payments, credit access, fraud detection, literacy	SDG 8, 9
Open Innovation	Any socially impactful solution using emerging technology	Multiple

4. Eligibility & Registration

4.1 Eligibility

- Open exclusively to currently enrolled EEC students, all programs, disciplines, and years. A valid student ID must be shown at onboarding.
- Organizing Committee members, official volunteers, mentors, and judges may not compete.
- Each student may register with one Team only; students on academic suspension or unresolved discipline are not eligible.
- Eligibility may be verified at any time; ineligible Participants may be disqualified without refund.

4.2 Registration & Fee

- Register online within the announced window: team name, track, member details, GitHub usernames, and a one-paragraph problem statement.
- Registrations pass a light screening step (eligibility, track balance, venue capacity — target ~20 teams / 80 participants); registration is complete only upon confirmation and fee payment.
- Fee: **NPR 25 per participant**, non-refundable except on event cancellation or screening rejection. Hardship waivers may be granted confidentially by the Event Lead.

5. Team Formation

- Teams have 2–4 members; teams of one may not compete alone. Solo registrants are matched into teams at the pre-event team-formation session.
- Cross-discipline and cross-batch teams are encouraged; participation of women, junior students, and first-timers is actively promoted.
- Each Team names one Team Leader as the single point of contact for communications, submissions, and appeals.
- Team composition locks at the opening ceremony; post-lock substitutions require the Event Lead's written approval for documented medical/emergency reasons only, and the substitute must meet all eligibility rules.
- Team names must be appropriate for a college setting; the Organizing Committee may require a rename.

6. Event Schedule

The 27-hour build clock runs from 09:00 on Day 1 (17 July) to the 12:00 noon hard deadline on Day 2 (18 July). All times are NPT, enforced by the master event clock. Mentorship rounds are also mandatory code-push checkpoints (Section 12).

Day 1 — 17th July 2026

Time	Activity
07:00 – 09:00	Onboarding: registration, ID check, kits, welcome tea
09:00 – 09:45	Opening ceremony — 27-hour clock begins
09:45 – 10:15	Theme & rules briefing, judging walkthrough, Q&A
10:15 – 12:00	Build sprint 1 + ideation (track selection locks 12:00)
12:00 – 12:30	Mentorship Round 1 — Faculty [code push due 12:00]
12:30 – 13:30	Lunch
13:30 – 15:30	Build sprint 2
15:30 – 16:00	Mentorship Round 2 — External experts [push due 15:30]
16:00 – 18:00	Build sprint 3
18:00 – 18:30	Mentorship Round 3 — SOCISE-EEC executives [push due 18:00]
18:30 – 19:30	Dinner
19:30 – 21:30	Build sprint 4
21:30 – 23:00	Mehfil — open-air live music session
23:00 – 23:30	Mentorship Round 4 — Organizing Committee [push due 23:00]
23:30 onward	Overnight build (supervised), refreshments, rest area open

Day 2 — 18th July 2026

Time	Activity
07:00 – 08:00	Breakfast
08:00 – 10:00	Build sprint 5 + checkpoint
10:00 – 10:30	Mentorship Round 5 — Faculty & experts [push due 10:00]
10:30 – 11:30	Final build sprint
11:30 – 12:00	Documentation & final touches
12:00	HARD SUBMISSION DEADLINE — clock stops
12:00 – 13:30	Pitching: preliminary round — booth demos
13:30 – 14:45	Pitching: final round — stage pitches
14:45 – 15:00	Judges' deliberation
15:00 – 16:00	Winner announcement & closing ceremony
16:00 – 16:30	Networking, photographs, departure

Meal times, the Mehfil, and other non-critical timings may shift with venue-wide announcement. The launch time, checkpoint times, and hard deadline change only under Force Majeure (Section 23).

7. Participation Rules

- **Attendance:** All members must attend onboarding and the opening ceremony; teams absent without notice by 10:15 Day 1 may forfeit their slot.
- **Presence:** At least one member must be at the team's workstation during every mentorship round.
- **ID:** Event ID must be worn at all times within the venue.
- **Mentor interaction:** Mentors advise; they do not write code or make product decisions for a team.
- **External help:** Assistance from anyone outside the registered Team is prohibited during the Build Window, except public documentation/forums and permitted AI tools (Section 9).
- **Rest:** Participants may rest at any time in designated rest areas; only outputs matter.
- **Withdrawal:** A Team may withdraw at any time by written notice to the Event Lead; fees are not refunded.

8. Project & Development Rules

8.1 Project Eligibility

- Projects must be substantially conceived and built within the Build Window. Pre-existing products, coursework, or previously submitted hackathon entries are not eligible.
- Before the Event, teams may research, sketch ideas, and set up environments/accounts — but no production code, trained custom models, or solution-specific designed assets before launch.
- The project must fit the Team's selected track and demonstrably address the official theme, and must be lawful and non-discriminatory.
- Judges and the Technical & IT Unit may inspect commit history, question teams on their code, and require a live re-demonstration to verify authenticity.

8.2 Development Rules

- All development occurs within the Build Window (09:00 Day 1 – 12:00 noon Day 2).
- Any language, framework, or platform may be used, subject to the AI and open-source policies below.
- All code, configuration, and assets must be pushed to the Official Repository — work only on a local machine at the deadline counts as not submitted.
- A minimum of one meaningful push before each of the five mentorship rounds is mandatory (Section 12).
- Teams must not attack, probe, or degrade the venue network or any other team's or third-party's systems — offensive-security behavior causes immediate disqualification.
- Code freeze is at the 12:00 noon hard deadline; the last commit at or before 12:00:00 NPT is the judged state.

9. AI Usage Policy

Use of AI tools — coding assistants, code-generation models, chat assistants, generative AI for text/image/audio — is recommended and encouraged, provided it is used responsibly.

9.1 Permitted

- Using AI to generate, refactor, debug, or explain code, provided the Team understands and can explain every part of the submission.
- Using generative AI for boilerplate, documentation drafts, UI copy, placeholder assets, and brainstorming.
- Using pre-trained models, foundation-model APIs, and open datasets, subject to license terms and disclosure below.

9.2 Obligations

- **Disclosure:** All significant AI assistance must be disclosed in the repository README (tools used and where). Non-disclosure is an integrity violation.
- **Understanding:** Every presenting member must be able to explain the design and code, including AI-generated parts.
- **Human ownership:** AI is a tool, not a team member — decisions and the pitch must reflect the Team's own judgment.
- **Data ethics:** No feeding personal/confidential/College-restricted data into third-party AI services without a lawful basis.
- **Fairness & harm:** Consider bias, misuse, and safety; undisclosed deepfakes and deceptive content are prohibited.
- **No fabrication:** Metrics, results, testimonials, or citations must never be fabricated, by AI or otherwise.

Judges reward transparent, well-engineered use of AI and penalize concealed or unethical use.

10. Open Source, Hardware & Intellectual Property

10.1 Open Source & Third-Party Software

- Open-source libraries, frameworks, SDKs, and public APIs may be used freely, respecting all license terms; each must be declared in the README (name, version, license, purpose).
- Copying substantial code from tutorials or other projects without attribution is plagiarism (Section 19).
- Judges assess what the Team itself built in 27 hours — integration is legitimate engineering, but original contribution must be substantial and identifiable.

10.2 Hardware & IoT

- Teams bring their own laptops, chargers, and any IoT/embedded hardware; the organizers do not lend competition hardware. All hardware must be declared at onboarding for a basic safety check.
- Soldering, non-standard batteries, high-voltage work, drones, and flame-producing equipment require prior written approval and may be refused. Physical prototypes must be assembled within the Build Window.

10.3 Intellectual Property & Licensing

- All IP in a submission belongs to the Team that created it; SOCISE-EEC and the College claim no ownership.
- By submitting, Teams grant the organizers a non-exclusive, royalty-free license to use the project name, screenshots, video, and pitch materials for archival, reporting, and promotion.
- Official Repositories remain accessible to organizers for verification and archival; teams may request transfer after the Event.
- The Event is not a confidential setting — teams should not present anything they need to keep secret.

11. Submission Guidelines

Every Team must complete its Submission before the hard deadline of 12:00 noon NPT on Day 2. All components below are mandatory.

Component	Requirement
Source code	Final code pushed to the Official Repository; last commit at/before 12:00:00 is judged.
README	Project name, team, track, problem, solution summary, setup/run steps, third-party components, AI-usage disclosure, known limitations.
Demo video	Maximum 3 minutes, showing the working prototype end-to-end.
Presentation deck	Business-perspective pitch deck (PDF/PPTX), see Section 13; committed under /docs.
Submission form	Official online form completed by the Team Leader, linking repository, video, and deck.

- Late submissions are not accepted — the platform closes automatically at the deadline; the master clock is authoritative.
- Partial/broken submissions are judged as-is; submit a working version early and iterate.
- Teams must be able to run their prototype live at booth demonstrations — video-only projects score zero on Technical Implementation.

12. GitHub & Development Evidence

- All development happens in the official SOCISE-SparkEEC GitHub organization. Each Team gets one private Official Repository with write access for all registered members; organizers retain admin access for verification.
- Teams must not change repository visibility, remove organizer access, force-push over history, or delete the repository.

A code push to the Official Repository is mandatory before every mentorship round:

Checkpoint	Push Due (NPT)	Mentorship Round
CP-1	Day 1, 12:00	Round 1 — Faculty
CP-2	Day 1, 15:30	Round 2 — External experts
CP-3	Day 1, 18:00	Round 3 — SOCISE-EEC executives
CP-4	Day 1, 23:00	Round 4 — Organizing Committee
CP-5	Day 2, 10:00	Round 5 — Faculty & external experts

- **Missed checkpoints:** 1st miss — warning; 2nd — 5% aggregate score deduction; 3rd — integrity referral and possible disqualification. Announced technical outages suspend enforcement for the affected period.
- Commit messages must be meaningful with all members appearing as authors over the Event; secrets (API keys) must never be committed — use environment variables.

13. Presentation & Pitching Rules

13.1 Two-Stage Pitching

- **Preliminary (12:00–13:30, Day 2):** Judges circulate booths; each Team gives a ~5-minute live demo plus questions.
- **Final (13:30–14:45, Day 2):** Shortlisted teams pitch on stage before the full panel — 6 minutes to pitch, 4 minutes Q&A, strictly timed.

13.2 Deck: Business Perspective

The deck must sell the venture from a business perspective, not narrate the codebase — technical depth is shown live and in the repository. Maximum 12 slides, PDF or PPTX, 16:9, committed under /docs. Required flow:

#	Slide	Must Answer
1	Title & one-liner	Team, project, one-sentence value proposition
2	Problem	Who hurts, how badly, with evidence
3	Target user & market	First user; market size (Nepal-first)
4	Solution & demo	What was built; screenshot/flow
5	How it works	Technology in one accessible diagram, incl. AI use
6	Business model	Who pays, pricing logic, unit economics
7	Go-to-market & competition	First channel; differentiation
8	Impact & SDGs	Measurable impact; explicit SDG target(s)
9	Roadmap & the ask	Next 3 months; what the team needs
10	Team	Who did what; why this team

- No fabricated data — every number needs a source or the label “team estimate”; AI-generated images/text must be identified. No new development after code freeze; teams must not disparage other teams during pitches or Q&A.

14. Official Judging Rubric

A seven-member panel scores from three professional perspectives. Each judge scores only their own panel's criteria (1–10 per criterion); weights convert raw scores to a panel score out of 100, then panels combine into the Team's aggregate score.

Panel	Judged By	Weight
A — Technology	2 senior engineers / technical leads	45%
B — Business	1 business expert + 2 Senior Judges (HoDs, final round)	30%
C — Investment	2 investors/VCs (or a 2nd business expert)	25%

Panel A — Technology (45%)

Criterion	Weight
Technical implementation & functionality	35%
Code quality & architecture	20%
Innovation in engineering	15%
Development evidence & authenticity (checkpoints, all members)	15%
Difficulty & completeness for 27 hours	15%

Panel B — Business (30%)

Criterion	Weight
Problem–solution fit	30%
Business model & viability	25%
User experience & design	20%
Go-to-market & competition	15%
Pitch & storytelling	10%

Panel C — Investment (25%)

Criterion	Weight
Market opportunity	30%
Scalability & defensibility	25%
Impact & SDG alignment	15%
Team capability	20%
Return & follow-on potential	10%

Preliminary booth scores shortlist teams for the final; final-round scores determine winners, with preliminary Technology scores carried forward at 30% of Panel A. Judges with a conflict of interest abstain from scoring that Team. Raw scores are confidential; judges' merit decisions are final and not appealable (procedural appeals only — Section 20).

15. Tie-Breaking Rules

If Teams tie on aggregate score, ties are broken in this order until resolved:

1. Higher Panel A (Technology) score
2. Higher Panel C (Investment) score
3. Higher Panel B (Business) score
4. Higher score on “Technical implementation & functionality”
5. Better checkpoint record, then earlier final submission timestamp
6. Casting decision of the panel chair with the two Senior Judges, recorded in writing

For the People's Choice award, ties are resolved by vote count; if still tied, the award is shared.

16. Code of Conduct & Academic Integrity

16.1 Code of Conduct

SparkEEC 1.0 is committed to a harassment-free, inclusive, respectful experience for everyone, regardless of gender, age, disability, appearance, caste, ethnicity, religion, program, or batch. This applies to all persons at the venue and on official online channels.

- **Expected:** Treat everyone with respect; follow OC/volunteer/security instructions; respect shared spaces and quiet hours; report concerns promptly.
- **Prohibited:** Harassment, discrimination, or unwelcome conduct; alcohol, tobacco, or illegal substances; sabotage of another team's work; theft or misuse of property; cheating or plagiarism; unauthorized persons at the venue.
- **Enforcement:** The Event Lead may issue a warning, score penalty, removal from venue, disqualification without refund, or College referral, proportionate to the violation. Retaliation against a reporter is itself a violation.

16.2 Academic Integrity

- **Plagiarism:** Presenting another's code, design, text, or ideas as the Team's own — including undisclosed AI content — is prohibited.
- **Pre-built work & fabrication:** Passing off pre-event work as built during the Build Window, or inventing data/results, is prohibited.
- **Ghost participation:** Work by non-team-members (friends, seniors, paid help) is prohibited.
- **Process:** Teams must cooperate with integrity checks. Suspected violations go to an integrity panel (Event Lead, one faculty mentor, judging panel chair); the Team is heard before any decision. Sanctions range from score deduction to disqualification, prize forfeiture, and College referral.

17. Safety, Overnight Stay & Venue Rules

17.1 Safety & Security

- A stocked first-aid station operates for all 27 hours; alert the nearest volunteer or OC member for any medical/safety emergency.
- Participants with relevant medical conditions are encouraged to disclose them confidentially at onboarding.
- Only venue-approved power strips, no daisy-chaining; entry is ID-controlled and the venue is supervised at all times including overnight.
- Participants are responsible for their own valuables; the organizers accept no liability for personal property.

17.2 Overnight Stay (Night of Day 1)

- The venue stays open under a supervised overnight protocol; separate rest areas for female and male participants are available from 23:30 — bring your own light bedding.
- Leaving overnight requires signing out/in at the help desk; quiet hours in rest areas are 23:30–06:30; visitors are not permitted overnight.
- At least two volunteers and one OC member (including female volunteers on every roster) are on duty overnight at all times.

17.3 Venue Rules

- Workstation assignments are made at onboarding; food/drink only in designated areas; smoking is prohibited campus-wide.
- Do not move furniture or tamper with electrical/network infrastructure; access is limited to event-designated areas.
- Each team clears its workstation before departure; damage to College property is chargeable to those responsible.

18. Food, Logistics & Media Policy

18.1 Food & Logistics

- Three meals are provided to every registered participant (vegetarian options always available), plus tea/coffee and snacks during breaks and the overnight build. Allergies/dietary needs must be declared at registration.
- Each participant receives an event kit (ID card and academic kit) at onboarding; Wi-Fi credentials are issued at onboarding, with backup connectivity and generator support on standby.

18.2 Media & Privacy

- The Documentation & Media Unit photographs/records the Event; by participating you consent to reasonable use of event media for reporting, archival, and promotion. To opt out of promotional use, notify the Documentation & Media Unit at onboarding.
- Registration data is used solely for organizing the Event and is not sold or shared beyond what is necessary (e.g., certificate printing).
- Booth demos and final pitches are public within the College — do not present anything you need to keep secret.

19. Organizer Rights, Appeals & Force Majeure

19.1 Organizer Rights

The Event Lead may amend this Rulebook or the schedule with notice through official channels; verify eligibility and audit repositories/hardware; refuse or disqualify any registration for breach of this Rulebook without refund; substitute judges/mentors while preserving the three-perspective model; withhold or reallocate awards on an integrity finding; and decide any matter not expressly covered by this Rulebook.

19.2 Appeals

- Appeals are on procedural grounds only (a rule misapplied, a scoring tabulation error, a wrongly recorded submission, a disputed conduct sanction) — judges' merit decisions are final and not appealable.
- Only the Team Leader may appeal, in writing at the help desk or by official email, stating the rule, facts, and remedy sought.
- Deadlines: Build Window/checkpoint appeals within 60 minutes of the event complained of; result appeals within 30 minutes of the winner announcement. Late appeals are not entertained.
- Decided by the Event Lead with one faculty mentor and the judging panel chair (none being the subject of the appeal); the written decision is final.

19.3 Force Majeure

The organizers are not liable for delay or failure caused by events beyond reasonable control (natural disasters, epidemics, strikes/bandhs, governmental orders, prolonged power/connectivity failure, campus emergencies). The Event Lead may pause the build clock, adjust the schedule, relocate, go partly online, postpone, or cancel the Event. If the clock is paused, checkpoint enforcement is suspended and resumes uniformly for all teams. Fees are refunded if the Event is cancelled before launch; if cancelled after launch, the organizers may recognize participation with certificates and decide fairly on any awards for work submitted up to that point.

20. Awards

Winners are determined by aggregate three-panel scores (Sections 14–15), except the People's Choice award, decided by open voting among EEC students and faculty.

Award	Recognition	Prize (NPR)
Champion (1st)	Trophy, certificates, mentorship & incubation support	10,000
1st Runner-up (2nd)	Trophy, certificates, mentorship	7,000
2nd Runner-up (3rd)	Trophy, certificates	5,000
Best AI Solution	Category trophy & certificates	2,000
Best Innovation	Category trophy & certificates	2,000
People's Choice	Voted by all EEC students & faculty; trophy & goodies	Goodies

- A team may win at most one of the top three placements plus at most one category award; all who submit receive participation certificates.
- Non-monetary benefits include internship/interview opportunities with partner companies (where offered) and incubation/mentorship pathways for the most promising projects.
- Cash prizes are disbursed to the Team Leader within 15 working days and divided among members by the Team itself; prizes may be withheld or recovered on a post-event integrity finding.

21. Pre-Submission Checklist

Team Leaders should verify every item before the 12:00 noon hard deadline on Day 2.

Area	Checklist Item
GitHub	Official Repository active; all 5 checkpoints (CP-1 to CP-5) pushed on time; final push at/before 12:00:00 NPT; no secrets committed
Repository contents	README complete with AI-usage disclosure and third-party declarations; deck committed under /docs; prototype runs live
Submission form	Demo video (≤ 3 min) uploaded; official form submitted with links; confirmation received
Booth readiness	Demo device charged; backup screenshots/video ready; all members briefed for Q&A